

boot-up you will note something quite unique. Sabayon developers have added music that plays while booting into the live mode only. So, even if you have a low-end PC, you still won't be bored by the old boot screen's progress bar. After the boot splash you will be asked to select the desktop type based on desktop effects. It not only allows you to switch between Compiz and a simple desktop, but also notifies you about your graphics adapter's compatibility with Compiz.

Finally, the desktop showed up. Figure 1 shows what the default desktop looks like. My initial impression was one of mild disappointment. Except the artwork, everything else was nearly the same as that of the 3.x edition. The placement and the number of icons haven't changed yet. The default desktop looks haphazard—having so many icons, I believe, can confuse a newbie.

As far as its hardware detection capabilities are concerned, it was unable to configure my resolution correctly. It chose to set it to a resolution of 1024 x 768 pixels instead of 1440 x 900.

I took a sneak peek at the installation options quickly, but there was nothing new to report. Sabayon uses the good-old Anaconda as its installer. It has added nearly all the major desktop environments (Figure 2), and has a specific installer option for Netbooks, which looks like a handy addition if you are using such hardware. The installer automatically adds KDE if you select GNOME, and vice versa.

The installation process is pretty awkward. Initially, it even installed KDE, although I had deselected it. However, at the end of the installation, it removed the deselected packages. Quite a waste of time, I'd say. The installation of deselected packages could have been skipped. In my system it took a total of 23 minutes. I personally have no issues with the time, as Sabayon installs quite a lot of packages. If you select all the options, then you might end up installing more than 12 GB of software.

Into the drive and what do I find?

Even after installation, Sabayon didn't set my resolution correctly despite the presence of ATI Catalyst drivers out of the box. I tried fiddling around with `xorg.conf`—even adding a new depth section and new resolutions, but to no avail. I was shocked that I couldn't use the `aticonfig` command even after the drivers were installed. Whatever I try, I just couldn't set my resolution correctly. Surprisingly, Mandriva using the same proprietary ATI driver (`fglrx`), sets everything correctly. Although it was unable to set my resolution correctly, it was able to set my graphics card to run Compiz right away (Figure 3).

Since Sabayon comes loaded with all the printer drivers and utilities, I thought it's time I set up my printer. I own a HP all-in-one 1410 printer, which has pretty good Linux support. I have used this printer with all the leading distros without any problems. To use it in Sabayon, I first opened the HP Device Manager. Although



Figure 1: Sabayon's default KDE 3.5.x desktop



Figure 2: Desktop selection screen on Sabayon's hard disk installer



Figure 3: The 3D desktop out-of-the-box

this application did detect my printer, it failed to add the respective drivers. So I manually selected the driver from the vast HP database and, to my surprise, in following the series of 'Next' steps, I got a prompt saying, "Printer not configured". This really irritated me, and I launched